MICHAEL CARRUTH

ENGINEERING MANAGER | AGENT & DEVELOPER PLATFORMS

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PROFILE

Engineering manager who builds platforms other teams build on. Founded the team behind Amazon Ads Agent and owned its LLM agent harness end to end: the agent loop, tool and MCP integration, guardrails, and the eval system that gates every release. Designed it as a shared orchestration layer that product teams across 5 VP orgs integrate with, and took it from an empty team to an unBoxed launch in under a year. 20 years leading platform and distributed-systems engineering at Amazon and Microsoft, including systems with 100M+ concurrent connections, and building teams from zero.

FOCUS

Agent Infrastructure on LLMs • Platform & Integration Design • Distributed Systems at Scale • Evals & Guardrails • Hiring & Growing Engineering Teams • Customer-Driven Roadmaps

EXPERIENCE

AMAZON | Senior Software Development Manager, Amazon Ads | 2026–Present

Ads Agent · advertising.amazon.com/solutions/products/ads-agent

- Founded the team and built Amazon Ads Agent, Amazon Ads' first agentic experience: advertisers describe what they want in plain language and get insights, recommendations, and actions across planning, campaign creation, optimization, and measurement for Sponsored Ads, DVA, and AMC.
- Owned the agent harness end to end: agent loop, tool and MCP integration, skills architecture, context management, and guardrails, plus the eval system that gates every release.
- Designed it as a single orchestration platform that product teams across 5 VP orgs plug their capabilities into, the first horizontal integration across Amazon Ads. Set the integration model and drove adoption across orgs.
- Shipped in 25 markets and 20+ languages, rolling out to 300K+ advertisers.
- Ads Agent was featured throughout unBoxed 2026; presented it in a breakout session with agency customer Harvest Group and fed customer feedback into the roadmap.
- Built the org from zero to 25 engineers and TPMs, including an SDM and three Principal TPMs; hired, coached, and ran performance management.

CAREER BREAK | Travel | 2022–2025

AMAZON | Senior Software Development Manager, Devices Software & Services | 2020–2022

Setup, Connectivity & IoT Platforms

- Scaled device setup and messaging platforms to 100M+ concurrent connections; cut latency in India by more than half.
- Killed a flawed revenue model three months before hardware launch, saving an $8M investment and holding the launch date.
- Recovered a failed device beta in two weeks by changing firmware behavior; ratings went from 2.0 to 4.5 stars.

AMAZON | Senior Software Development Manager, Advertising | 2019–2020
Sponsored Brands & Video

- Grew the org from 50 to 75+ people across two sites on multi-billion-dollar ad platforms.
- Launched Advertiser Strategies, driving 25%+ year-over-year growth in advertiser spend.

AMAZON | Senior Software Development Manager, Devices Software & Services | 2014–2019
Offline Retail Platform

- Built the platform behind Amazon device sales through 500 retailers in 15 countries, including Amazon's first 100+ physical kiosks.
- Automated sales and operations planning: 75% lower cost, monthly cycles to daily, out-of-stocks cut in half.
- Founded the Denver engineering site and grew it from zero to 25 engineers.

MICROSOFT | Principal Software Development Manager, Bing Ads | 2008–2014

- Took Microsoft Advertising Editor from limited beta to GA; usage grew 200x. Gold Star Award.
- Shipped self-service Google Ads import, a major driver of advertiser growth.

MICROSOFT | Principal Software Development Manager, Windows | 2004–2008

- Led the Application Compatibility Toolkit team.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

LLM agent infrastructure: agent loops, tool and MCP integration, skills, context management, guardrails, eval systems. Distributed systems on AWS: high-scale messaging and device connectivity (100M+ concurrent connections). Multi-team platform integration. Advertising platforms.

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

B.S., Computer Science, Auburn University
Amazon Bar Raiser | Microsoft Gold Star Award | ADP Innovation Excellence Award